

EVIL

- +-> moral: freely caused cruelty, oppression, betrayal
- +-> natural: disease, earthquake, congenital suffering
- +-> horrendous: suffering that threatens life's overall meaning
- +-> animal/evolutionary: pain predating human agency

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PROBLEM TYPES

- logical: God and evil are strictly inconsistent
- evidential: amount/kinds of evil make God improbable
- existential: suffering disrupts trust, worship and meaning.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/8: 2. Logical problem and defence

CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists
missing premise: a good, powerful being eliminates every evil it can

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PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE

significant freedom -> possibility of moral wrong

God cannot cause a creature to choose freely and guarantee only right choices

transworld depravity shows logical possibility of unavoidable misuse

RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/8: 3. Soul-making and natural order

IRENÆUS / JOHN HICK

epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk -> genuine agency

struggle -> courage, compassion, responsibility -> person-making

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strength: addresses why a ready-made paradise may defeat mature freedom

objections: victims used as means; suffering is excessive and uneven;

infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers

reply requires afterlife fulfilment/universal restoration, which adds further commitments.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/8: 4. Leibniz, Augustine and process revisions

AUGUSTINE: evil is privatio boni, not a created substance; misuse of freedom disorders good

LEIBNIZ: best possible world balances laws, freedom and total compossibility

AQUINAS: God may permit evil for a greater good, never will evil as evil

PROCESS THEISM: God persuades but cannot unilaterally prevent every event

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COSTS: privation does not lessen felt horror; “best” can seem complacent;

greater-good reasoning risks instrumentalising victims; process view revises omnipotence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/8: 5. Evidential evil

ROWE: apparently pointless suffering exists; an omnipotent good God would prevent it;
therefore God's existence is improbable

hidden fawn case tests gratuitous natural suffering without human freedom

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SKEPTICAL THEISM: limited human cognition cannot infer “no reason” from “no reason seen”

CORNEA: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected

objection: too much scepticism also weakens providential and moral reasoning

verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/8: 6. Indian response matrix

ADVAITA: suffering belongs to vyāvahārika avidyā; ultimate Brahman is non-dual

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: real souls/world, karma, grace and purposeful divine order

NYĀYA: beginningless karma allocated by Īśvara; God is not arbitrary author of deserts

JAINA: karmic matter binds jīva; no creator bears responsibility

BUDDHISM: duḥkha from dependent origination, craving and ignorance; no creator problem

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KARMA explains moral continuity but faces first-origin, victim-blaming and natural-evil pressures;

liberation routes answer suffering therapeutically, not always as a theodicy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/8: 7. Hard cases and ethical limits

TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST

child suffering | animal pain | genocide | disability | unequal opportunity | hiddenness

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ASK: does response explain, merely defend logical possibility, or offer pastoral meaning?

does it preserve victim dignity? does it make preventable evil morally acceptable?

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anti-theodicy warning: neat justification can repeat harm

reply: philosophical explanation need not command passive acceptance;

moral protest may itself express commitment to goodness.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/8: 8. PYQ and answer synthesis

DEFINE God-concept + evil type -> separate logical/evidential/existential demand

-> formal argument -> strongest defence/theodicy -> hard-case objection

-> Indian comparison on karma/duḥkha -> qualified verdict

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10 marks: one problem + one response + evaluation

15 marks: logical/evidential distinction + two responses

20 marks: Western and Indian matrix + hard cases + concept revision

CLOSE: evil may not disprove every God-concept, but it severely tests classical omni-God belief and forces costs in freedom, providence, power, afterlife or human understanding.